

TITLE: Records Retention Policy
ORGANIZATION: Northwind Analytics, Inc.
DEPARTMENT: Compliance
SENSITIVITY: Internal
VERSION: 1.0
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Records Retention Policy

1. Purpose

Defines minimum and maximum retention periods for key record categories to meet legal/regulatory obligations while minimizing unnecessary data retention risk.

2. Retention Schedule (Selected Categories)

Record Category	Retention Period
Employment records (offer letters, performance reviews)	7 years after termination
Payroll and tax records	7 years
Contracts (signed)	Duration of contract + 7 years
Customer support tickets	3 years
Marketing/CRM data for non-customers	2 years of inactivity, then purged or anonymized
Security incident records	7 years (compliance/audit requirement)

3. Legal Holds

Records subject to a litigation hold or active regulatory inquiry must be preserved regardless of the standard retention schedule until Legal confirms the hold is released.

4. Disposal

Records past their retention period should be securely disposed of (digital: secure deletion; physical: shredding) on a quarterly disposal cycle, coordinated by Compliance.

5. Contact

compliance@company.com